

Remember Where You Came From

PRIMARY TEXTS: DEUTERONOMY 32, 34

In modern Christianity, we often focus on heaven—what is coming next, later, or after—if we can just survive the now. Yet, by overlooking the present, and even the past, are we missing the point of the Story and the role the Church is asked to be playing in it?

Moses, the man no other prophet would rise to be like in Torah. No one else knew God like Moses. Intimately. Face to face. Close enough to touch and even embrace.

I find something beautifully challenging in the closeness of Moses and God. What if I lived my life in such closeness with God, that it was like the Kingdom was here—now—radiating little glimpses of heaven, like a flower girl who drops petals to usher in the bride? I didn't just create a space for Him, but he filled all there possibly was to fill?

If my desire wasn't to reach or get to heaven, but simply to be near God, to know Him more—so near that He could wrap His arms around me, and mine around Him?

**What if... just
being near Him
was the point?**

What if my mistakes, my failures, and even my triumphs and successes, were no longer the point, but just being near Him was the point?

For Moses, remembering where he came from must have been painful. A look at wrongs against him and against others. There were times where Moses may have lost this plot, but at his core he was one who had understood it the best. This was the Moses who barely escaped death as an infant, killed the Egyptian, ran from his home, tried to hide from his true identity, and let anger get the best of him at times.

**... awe in the
promise of
God to provide**

Yet he could look back at his time in Egypt, his first time in the wilderness, return to the empire as an outcast, and take a second journey into the desert as a leader. At the enslavement of his people, the burning bush, the miracles of his staff, and his awe in the promise of God to provide—and to forgive.

This same Moses did not forget the river he was rescued from, the women who stretched out their hands to save him, the mother who nursed him, the sister who celebrated with him, the people who followed him, and the God who called him. Was Moses's final destination, or greatest desire, to enter the Promised Land, or was it just to be and experience the journey with God that his ancestors hoped he'd never forget?

At this point in the Story, what should we not forget—both from the Text and our own pasts?

Hopefully there are images, of the desert and the garden, that remind you of where you come from and where you belong.

Hopefully there are people, in the Text and sitting around the room near you, who do not let you forget—who remind you that there is life and wisdom in looking back and remembering. That this lens softens our hearts, building empathy and understanding with those we are like and those we are not, and teaches us not just what to do, but how to rest, celebrate, love, and live. How to invite others into that space with us—perhaps, most importantly, the foreigner, the orphan, and the widow. Those who may need someone in the desert to help them find and recognize the voice of the Shepherd so that they may never forget it as well.

**There is life and
wisdom in
looking back and
remembering**

We always will carry the weight—somehow heavy yet light—of our pasts, but we can choose to not forget where we came from to help us learn, grow, and even find comfort in order to bring about the Kingdom on earth just as Moses brought his people to the Promised Land. A choice not just focused on our individual stories reaching a “happily ever after,” but one part of the collective whole, the community, that needs to see and be reminded of true intimacy with God, so that everyone can’t help but desire it too.

PRAYER

Our Father in Heaven,

*Let Your words fall like new rain
watering the creation we walk and work.
Reminding us of Your ways
so that we may never forget where we came from.*

*May we remember our own time in the desert
that we may embrace the foreigner, orphan, and widow,
inviting them into our own sabbaths and celebrations.*

*As we look forward, may we also look back,
never forgetting where you have brought us from and led us to.
May we take all your Words to heart,
for they are not idle, but active, bringing us to life.*

*As You water the earth, may You continue to water our souls,
and make this so.*

Amen

THE FOUR PILLARS

EPISODE 31

BEMA Discipleship is built on four pillars; a **Four-Pillared Perspective** to help us remember **to elevate the words of God** (not ours) and help us identify the principles that we see recurring in the Story of God's people.

Here are some applications for this episode echoing the ideas of the four pillars:



TEXT

What might be important to dig into again, meditate over, or memorize from these passages in Deuteronomy? What part of the Text may you want to just sit with?



COMMUNITY

How does your community remember where it has come from? How does, or could, your community circle around those often left in the margins of society, or even the church?



DISCIPLESHIP

Who can you walk alongside to show the importance of remembering where you've come from and learning from those memories? To model how to love and serve as the people of God are called to do in Deuteronomy?



WRESTLING

What are you wrestling with? Moses not entering the Promised Land or the depiction of being face to face with God? Why the call to surround the weak is so prominent? Remember, questions and wrestling are good! Especially in community.



Are you a music listener?

Listen along to our BEMA Music Playlists on Spotify.

Song suggestions? Send them to bemabesorah@gmail.com.



BEMA SESSION 1



MEDITATION & PRAYER

REFLECTION, APPLICATION & IMPACT

There are three emphases we are always thinking about in terms of application at BEMA. These may be stated explicitly at times, but often we will want you to do the work of finding ways to connect the dots to the things we are learning. Much of this is what makes the work of BEMA distinct as a ministry of Impact Campus Ministries.

CREATING A SPACE SPIRITUAL FORMATION

*We believe that **if we do our part in creating space for God, He will fill it**, and the more we let Him fill that space, the closer we are to Him. You can't have a close relationship with someone you don't spend repeated quality time with—and God is here waiting. What spiritual practices might you try out to connect with God more? How might the smallest practice fill you with more of Him to better lead others? What practice could you refine, pick up again, or challenge yourself to try for the first time? If you create the space, He will fill it.*

CONSIDERING CAMPUS YOUNG PEOPLE FOCUS

*We believe young adults are shaping the future, and they need to see what it looks like to surround and come alongside the foreigner, orphan, and widow—you can model this to the young adults around you. Because they are watching! **They need to see what it looks like to follow God and pursue an intimate, face-to-face relationship with Him.** Be on the lookout for those young people who may cross your path to show them the beauty and power of remembering where we came from.*

SACRED STATION THEOLOGY OF WORK

*Imagine how our world, our theology of work, might be different if we chose to embrace and rally around the outcasts of society—the foreigner, orphan, and widow? Living in intimacy with God is how you can live this way as you pursue your 9–5. Does your physical work put you in a position to lead others the way Jesus calls us to? The way we manage our employees, interact with customers or coworkers, care for our children, treat the least of these, or create products can make an impact. **You are doing sacred work and God is there to continue this work in and through you in whatever sacred space you are in. Remember where you came from as you go about your days—don't lose the plot of the Story.***